

Structure: Introduction to Active and Passive

A statement is in the active voice if the subject of the sentence performs the action. Examples

The man killed the goat. Here the subject “the man” is the doer of the action

Passive voice

A statement is in the passive voice if the subject of the sentence does not perform any action. Here the subject is passive, the subject. Example. The goat was killed by the man.

In changing a sentence from active to passive voice, care should be taken to maintain the tense.

More samples of active and passive

Active voice

1. Present simple tense

The teacher owns a school

Passive

A school is owned by a teacher

The boy rides a bicycle

A bicycle is ridden by the boy

2. Present continuous tense

Active

We are eating pounded yam

Passive

Pounded yam is being eaten by us

3. Present perfect tense

Active

I have finished the job

We have cancelled the match

Passive

The job has been finished

The match has been cancelled by us.

4. Present perfect continuous tense

That girl has been practicing the dance

I have been buying clothes

The dance has been being practiced by the girl

Clothes has been being bought by me

5. Past simple tense

I bought the book this morning

A car hit the dog

The book was bought by me this morning

The dog was hit by a car

6. Past continuous tense

You were washing your clothes

I was riding a bicycle

Your clothes were being washed by you

A bicycle was being ridden by me

7. Past perfect tense

We had finished the job

The boy had climbed the stairs

The job had been finished by us

The stairs had been climbed by the boy

8. Past perfect continuous tense

Tony had been jumping the fence

He had been clearing the forest

The fence had been being jumped by Tony

The forest had been being cleared by him.

9. Simple future tense

The boy will buy the books

Emeka will visit me

The books will be bought by the boy

I will be visited by Emeka

10. The future continuous tense

I shall be receiving lectures

They will be buying the buckets

Lectures shall be being received by me

The bucket will be being bought by them

Lectures shall be being received by me.

Assignment

Write out ten sentences showing the active and the passive tenses.